

Create Your First App with Android Studio

Android Studio is a new Android development environment developed by Google. It is based on IntelliJ IDEA, which is similar to Eclipse with the ADT plugin. Let's get familiar with the installation of Android Studio and some of the precautions that must be taken during installation.



Android is gaining market share and opening up new horizons for those who want to develop Android apps. Android app development doesn't require any investments because all the tools needed for it are free. It has been quite a while since Android app development began and most of us are aware of how things work. Just install Java, then install Eclipse, download the ADT (Android Development Toolkit) bundle, do a bit of configuration and you are all set to develop Android apps. Google provides us with a new IDE called Android Studio, which is based on IntelliJ IDEA. It is different from Eclipse in many ways. The most basic difference is that you don't have to do any configuration like you would have to for Eclipse. Android Studio comes bundled with the Android ADT, and all you need to do is to point it to where Java is installed on your system. In this article, I will cover a few major differences between Android Studio and the Eclipse+ADT plugin methods. Android Studio is currently available as an 'easy access preview' or developer preview, so several features will not be available and there are chances that you may encounter bugs.

First, let's install Android Studio. I'm assuming yours is a Windows OS with pre-installed JDK as the developer

machine's configuration. One thing to check is that the JDK version is later than version 6. Next, go to the link: <http://developer.android.com/sdk/installing/studio.html>. Here, you'll see the button for downloading Android Studio. The Web page automatically recognises your OS and provides you with the compatible version. If you need to download for some other OS, just click on 'Download for other Platforms' (refer to Figure 1). Once downloaded, you can follow the set-up wizard. There might be a few challenges. For example, at times, for Windows systems, the launcher script isn't able to find Java. So you need to set an environment variable called JAVA_HOME and point it to your JDK folder. If you are on Windows 8, you can follow these steps to set an environment variable: click on *Computer -> Properties -> Advanced System Settings -> Advanced Tab* (on the *System Properties Dialogue*) -> *Environment Variables*. Then, under *System Variables*, click on *New*.

Another problem might be the PATH variable. In the same manner as above, reach the *Environment Variable* dialogue box, and there, instead of creating a new variable, find the existing PATH variable and edit it. To the existing value, just add a semicolon at the end (if it's not already there) and add the path to the